aiming to cause maximum damage, in the expectation that the resulting debate will outweigh the harm done.

Arbitrary power is the great grievance of the Snowden camp. Who gave the NSA and GCHQ the power to bug and snoop? The real answer to that is simple: the elected governments and leaders of those countries, the judges and lawmakers who have the constitutional authority to supervise intelligence services, and the directors of the agencies in the exercise of their lawful powers. You may not like the system. You may think it needs improving (I do). But never in the history of intelligence has supervision been stronger. America in particular stands out as a country that has taken the most elusive and lawless part of government and crammed it into a system of legislative and judicial oversight. Greenwald simply dismisses such arrangements. For those in search of reform, he argues, 'the answer definitely does not lie in the typical processes of democratic accountability that we are all taught to respect'.[58] Instead, he thinks the answer lies in international pressure on America. Shame and destruction, not votes, laws and institutions, bring about reform.

The question about arbitrary power actually deserves to be posed in the other direction. What constitutional authority do the *Guardian*, *Der Spiegel* or the *New York Times* have? What gives them the right to leak their countries' most closely guarded secrets, obtained at vast expense, and with the sacrifice of tens of thousands of man-hours? Even the most passionate defenders of press freedom would hesitate to say that editors are the supreme guardians of the national interest. And even the most self-important editor would hesitate to claim omniscience. What expertise do editors and journalists have in handling these stolen secrets? How can they judge that a particular programme is worthy of exposure (rendering it useless overnight and perhaps endangering those who have worked on it) and